

Joshua Says

Armored ServiceNow: Customer Service Management

For people who already know the easy version.

Advanced practice for agents, admins and service owners on the CRM side of the platform

by Joshua

V1. Written from the platform's public documentation as of the date below. Check every key against the source area named in *Check the work* before relying on it; corrections are dated and kept public.

20 items · V1 · 2026-09-15

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How to run it

- 1 Read the target word first.** Write it on the line before you read the options. The platform disguises the question in the noun it uses — case or incident, skill or agent, queue or division, total or per unit.
- 2 Name the one fact that decides.** Everything else in the stem is camouflage: the deadline, the executive, the numbers, the object's name.
- 3 Principle before configuration.** Say what the platform construct is *for*, then pick the construct.
- 4 Confusion sets are the platform's favourite trap.** Every wrong option is a real thing. The test is exact role-matching, not recognition.
- 5 Mark confidence honestly.** Sure-and-wrong is a wrong mental model, and it is the only thing worth finding.
- 6 Grade in Part B.** Each distractor carries the error it encodes. Name the mold you fell for; naming it defeats it.

Check the work — sources

Every item is written from public documentation. Before trusting a key, check it against the source area named here; corrections are dated and kept public.

ServiceNow Product Documentation — Customer Service Management	docs.servicenow.com › CSM (cases, accounts, contacts, entitlements, Agent Workspace, playbooks, Advanced Work Assignment)
ServiceNow Product Documentation — Customer Service Portal and Communities	docs.servicenow.com › Service Portal / Communities
ServiceNow University — CIS-CSM mainline blueprint	learning.servicenow.com (public exam outline; no exam item reproduced)

The seven molds: dropped element · wrong stem number · adjacent category · inverted operation · absolute language · confusion set · camouflage (the option that answers a stem fact that was never the question).

Part A — Items

1. Case vs incident

An external customer emails that her subscription renewed at the wrong price. An internal employee reports his laptop will not boot. Same instance, same day. Which tables?

- A. Both incidents
- B. A case for the employee, an incident for the customer
- C. The customer's issue is a Case (CSM); the employee's is an Incident (ITSM)
- D. Both cases

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

2. Account, contact, consumer

A B2B customer's IT director opens a case; separately, an individual who bought one device at retail opens one. How is each person modelled?

- A. The director is an Account
- B. Both as Consumers
- C. Both as Contacts
- D. The director is a Contact under an Account; the retail buyer is a Consumer

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

3. Entitlements

A customer demands 24x7 phone support. Their contract covers business-hours email support only. Where should the agent be able to see that, and what enforces it?

- A. The customer portal FAQ
- B. Entitlements linked to the account/contract, checked on the case and used to drive SLA and channel
- C. The account's notes field
- D. The SLA definition alone

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

4. Case SLAs

Premium accounts get a 2-hour first response; standard get 8. One SLA definition exists with an 8-hour duration. What is the right design?

- A. Two SLA definitions with conditions on the account's service level (or entitlement), each with its own duration and schedule
- B. Edit the duration to 2 for everyone
- C. An assignment rule
- D. A business rule that changes priority

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

5. Advanced Work Assignment

Chat cases should go to the agent with the fewest open chats who has the 'Billing' skill and is available. Which capability, and what is configured?

- A. Round-robin by group
- B. An assignment rule on the case table
- C. Advanced Work Assignment — queues, skills, agent capacity and availability, with an assignment rule pushing work to agents in a workspace inbox
- D. On-call scheduling

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

6. Agent Workspace

Agents complain about tab-switching between the case, the customer's history, knowledge, and chat. Which UI is designed for that, and what is it built from?

- A. Service Portal
- B. A dashboard
- C. The classic form with related lists
- D. Agent Workspace (configurable workspace) — lists, record pages, ribbon components, contextual side panel, built in UI Builder

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

7. Playbooks

A refund case must follow six ordered steps with hand-offs between billing and support, and the agent should see progress as a timeline. Which construct?

- A. Case tasks created manually
- B. A playbook (Process Automation Designer) rendered in the workspace
- C. A UI policy
- D. A knowledge article with a checklist

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

8. Case types and record producers

On the portal, 'Report a billing problem' and 'Ask a product question' should open cases with different fields and different routing. How?

- A. Two record producers writing to the case table with different variables and defaults (case type/category), feeding different assignment
- B. One record producer and a dropdown
- C. Two knowledge bases
- D. Two case tables

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

9. Major issue management

A software defect affects 400 customers; each is opening a case. Support wants one place to fix and communicate, and every customer case updated when it is resolved. Which capability?

- A. An order guide
- B. A problem record
- C. Major issue management — a parent major case with child cases (and optional proactive cases), resolution propagated to children
- D. A knowledge article

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

10. Proactive customer service

A monitored device fleet reports a fault before customers notice. Support wants cases opened automatically for the affected install base. What must exist?

- A. An SLA
- B. A consumer record for each device
- C. A knowledge base
- D. Install base records (sold products/installed assets) linked to accounts, so an event can create proactive cases against them

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

11. Case escalation

A customer asks to 'escalate' a case that is within SLA and correctly assigned. What does escalation mean on the platform?

- A. Reassigning to a manager
- B. A managed escalation request — a record with reason, approver and tracking, distinct from priority and SLA
- C. Automatically raising priority to 1
- D. Nothing; escalation is informal

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

12. Knowledge and case deflection

Portal search shows articles as the customer types a case description; the case volume for password resets drops 30%. Which mechanism is at work?

- A. Knowledge deflection from the record producer / portal search, with deflection tracked on the knowledge feedback
- B. A playbook
- C. Virtual Agent
- D. An SLA

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

13. Communities

Customers want to answer each other's questions and have accepted answers become searchable. Which capability?

- A. Service catalog
- B. Live chat
- C. Communities — forums, questions, accepted answers, optionally harvested into knowledge
- D. Case comments

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

14. Omni-channel

Phone (via CTI), chat, email and a web form all create cases. Agents should see channel and be routed by channel capacity. What ties this together?

- A. A separate table per channel
- B. A dashboard
- C. Email only
- D. Channel-aware intake (CTI/OpenFrame, chat via AWA, inbound email actions, record producers) into one case table, with AWA capacity per channel

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

15. Special handling notes

A VIP account has an instruction: 'Never call after 6 pm; always cc the account manager.' Agents keep missing it in the account notes. Which feature surfaces it?

- A. A knowledge article
- B. Special handling notes — displayed prominently on the case/account in the workspace
- C. A UI policy
- D. An entitlement

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

16. Outsourced customer service

A partner company handles tier-1 support for one product line and must see only those accounts' cases. Which model?

- A. Partner/outsourced service — partner accounts and contacts with restricted access to the cases they serve
- B. Give partner staff the admin role
- C. A community
- D. A separate instance

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

17. Satisfaction surveys

After case closure, a survey should go out, and the score should be reportable by agent and account. Which capability?

- A. A knowledge feedback
- B. An SLA
- C. Survey/assessment triggered on case closure with results reportable
- D. A closure note

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

18. Case action status and state

A case is In Progress but the ball is with the customer. Agents want the list to show that at a glance without changing the state. Which field?

- A. Escalation
- B. Priority
- C. Assignment group
- D. Action status (e.g., Awaiting info) alongside State

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

19. Customer Service Portal

Customers need to open cases, see their own cases only, read knowledge, and chat. Which delivery, and what governs 'their own cases only'?

- A. Agent Workspace with limited roles
- B. The Customer Service Portal (Service Portal) with ACLs/queries restricting cases to the contact's account
- C. Email only
- D. Communities

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

20. Service organization vs account hierarchy

A global customer has regional subsidiaries; cases should roll up to the parent for reporting while each region keeps its contacts. How is this modelled?

- A. Account hierarchy — parent/child accounts, with contacts on the child accounts and reporting rolled up
- B. Consumers for each region
- C. One account with all contacts
- D. Separate instances

Target word: _____ The one fact that decides: _____
Answer: _____ [] sure [] unsure [] guess

STOP

Answers ahead. Finish Part A and mark every confidence box, then turn.

Part B — Key and dissection

1. Case vs incident — C

Rule. Case = external customer issue. Incident = internal service disruption.

Target word. EXTERNAL customer vs INTERNAL employee **Decides.** CSM serves customers; ITSM serves the workforce.

Camouflage, struck. ~~same instance, same day~~

A	dropped element	Both incidents
B	inverted operation	A case for the employee, an incident for the customer
C	KEY	The customer's issue is a Case (CSM); the employee's is an Incident (ITSM)
D	dropped element	Both cases

2. Account, contact, consumer — D

Rule. Account (company) → Contacts (people). Consumer = individual customer with no account.

Target word. B2B person vs B2C person **Decides.** Contact belongs to an account; consumer stands alone.

Camouflage, struck. ~~one device at retail~~

A	adjacent category	The director is an Account
B	dropped element	Both as Consumers
C	dropped element	Both as Contacts
D	KEY	The director is a Contact under an Account; the retail buyer is a Consumer

3. Entitlements — B

Rule. Contract → entitlement → case eligibility and SLA.

Target word. what they are ENTITLED to **Decides.** Entitlement records tie contract terms to service.

Camouflage, struck. 24×7

A	confusion set	The customer portal FAQ
B	KEY	Entitlements linked to the account/contract, checked on the case and used to drive SLA and channel
C	dropped element	The account's notes field
D	adjacent category	The SLA definition alone

4. Case SLAs — A

Rule. One definition per commitment; conditions decide which case gets which.

Target word. different terms by ACCOUNT **Decides.** Conditions select which SLA attaches.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	KEY	Two SLA definitions with conditions on the account's service level (or entitlement), each with its own duration and schedule
B	dropped element	Edit the duration to 2 for everyone
C	confusion set	An assignment rule
D	adjacent category	A business rule that changes priority

5. Advanced Work Assignment — C

Rule. AWA routes work items to agents; assignment rules route records to groups.

Target word. fewest open · has the skill · available **Decides.** Push assignment with capacity and skills is AWA.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	adjacent category	Round-robin by group
B	adjacent category	An assignment rule on the case table
C	KEY	Advanced Work Assignment — queues, skills, agent capacity and availability, with an assignment rule pushing work to agents in a workspace inbox
D	confusion set	On-call scheduling

6. Agent Workspace — D

Rule. Agent Workspace for fulfillers; Service Portal for customers.

Target word. one screen, in context **Decides.** Workspace is the agent UI; portal is the customer UI.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	confusion set	Service Portal
B	adjacent category	A dashboard
C	adjacent category	The classic form with related lists
D	KEY	Agent Workspace (configurable workspace) — lists, record pages, ribbon components, contextual side panel, built in UI Builder

7. Playbooks — B

Rule. Playbook = process stages shown to the agent; tasks alone are not a process.

Target word. ordered steps · timeline **Decides.** Playbooks orchestrate stages and activities visually.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	dropped element	Case tasks created manually
B	KEY	A playbook (Process Automation Designer) rendered in the workspace
C	confusion set	A UI policy
D	adjacent category	A knowledge article with a checklist

8. Case types and record producers — A

Rule. Record producers vary the front door, not the table.

Target word. different fields · different routing **Decides.** Record producers shape intake; the case table stays one.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	KEY	Two record producers writing to the case table with different variables and defaults (case type/category), feeding different assignment
B	dropped element	One record producer and a dropdown
C	confusion set	Two knowledge bases
D	inverted operation	Two case tables

9. Major issue management — C

Rule. Major case = one root, many children, one communication.

Target word. 400 customers · one fix **Decides.** Parent/child cases with propagation.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	confusion set	An order guide
B	adjacent category	A problem record
C	KEY	Major issue management — a parent major case with child cases (and optional proactive cases), resolution propagated to children
D	dropped element	A knowledge article

10. Proactive customer service — D

Rule. Install base → affected customers → proactive cases.

Target word. BEFORE customers notice **Decides.** Proactive service needs the install base to know who has what.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	confusion set	An SLA
B	adjacent category	A consumer record for each device
C	confusion set	A knowledge base
D	KEY	Install base records (sold products/installed assets) linked to accounts, so an event can create proactive cases against them

11. Case escalation — B

Rule. Priority is impact; escalation is attention.

Target word. escalate ≠ priority **Decides.** Escalation is its own object with its own workflow.

Camouflage, struck. within SLA

A	adjacent category	Reassigning to a manager
B	KEY	A managed escalation request — a record with reason, approver and tracking, distinct from priority and SLA
C	inverted operation	Automatically raising priority to 1
D	absolute language	Nothing; escalation is informal

12. Knowledge and case deflection — A

Rule. Deflection = answer before the case exists; measure it.

Target word. as the customer TYPES **Decides.** Contextual search on the intake form is deflection.

Camouflage, struck. 30%

A	KEY	Knowledge deflection from the record producer / portal search, with deflection tracked on the knowledge feedback
B	confusion set	A playbook
C	adjacent category	Virtual Agent
D	confusion set	An SLA

13. Communities — C

Rule. Communities = customer-to-customer; cases = customer-to-agent.

Target word. answer EACH OTHER **Decides.** Peer support is Communities.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	confusion set	Service catalog
B	adjacent category	Live chat
C	KEY	Communities — forums, questions, accepted answers, optionally harvested into knowledge
D	dropped element	Case comments

14. Omni-channel — D

Rule. Many doors, one room.

Target word. one table · channel capacity **Decides.** Channels differ at intake; the case is one.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	inverted operation	A separate table per channel
B	confusion set	A dashboard
C	dropped element	Email only
D	KEY	Channel-aware intake (CTI/OpenFrame, chat via AWA, inbound email actions, record producers) into one case table, with AWA capacity per channel

15. Special handling notes — B

Rule. Instruction that must be seen → special handling note.

Target word. agents keep MISSING it **Decides.** Special handling notes are designed to be seen.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	adjacent category	A knowledge article
B	KEY	Special handling notes — displayed prominently on the case/account in the workspace
C	confusion set	A UI policy
D	adjacent category	An entitlement

16. Outsourced customer service — A

Rule. Partner relationship + access scoping, not roles alone.

Target word. see ONLY those accounts **Decides.** Partners are modelled, and access is scoped.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	KEY	Partner/outsourced service — partner accounts and contacts with restricted access to the cases they serve
B	absolute language	Give partner staff the admin role
C	confusion set	A community
D	inverted operation	A separate instance

17. Satisfaction surveys — C

Rule. Trigger on state; report on the assessment table.

Target word. after closure · reportable **Decides.** Surveys are triggered assessments.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	adjacent category	A knowledge feedback
B	confusion set	An SLA
C	KEY	Survey/assessment triggered on case closure with results reportable
D	dropped element	A closure note

18. Case action status and state — D

Rule. State = lifecycle; action status = who has the ball.

Target word. without changing the STATE **Decides.** Action status is orthogonal to state.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	adjacent category	Escalation
B	confusion set	Priority
C	dropped element	Assignment group
D	KEY	Action status (e.g., Awaiting info) alongside State

19. Customer Service Portal — B

Rule. Portal = channel. ACL = scope.

Target word. their OWN cases only **Decides.** Portal for customers; access rules enforce scope.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	adjacent category	Agent Workspace with limited roles
B	KEY	The Customer Service Portal (Service Portal) with ACLs/queries restricting cases to the contact's account
C	dropped element	Email only
D	confusion set	Communities

20. Service organization vs account hierarchy — A

Rule. Parent account contains child accounts; contacts live where they work.

Target word. ROLL UP · keep contacts local **Decides.** Hierarchy gives both.

Camouflage, struck. —

A	KEY	Account hierarchy — parent/child accounts, with contacts on the child accounts and reporting rolled up
B	inverted operation	Consumers for each region
C	dropped element	One account with all contacts
D	inverted operation	Separate instances

Part C — Triage

Sort every item by the two marks you made. Write item numbers in the cells.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned. Bank it.	Wrong model. Top priority. Say the rule aloud; find the construct in the documentation.
Unsure	Recognition, not mastery. Redo from the rule.	Not learned. Read the rule, then the source area.
Guess	Luck. Treat as not learned.	Not learned.

Mold tally. dropped element ____ · wrong stem number ____ · adjacent category ____ · inverted operation ____ · absolute language ____ · confusion set ____ · camouflage ____ · The largest number is the pattern to drill.

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